

قوة العقل

POWER OF MIND



كيف تتحكم في أفكارك، باعادة برمجة عقلك،
وتبني عاداتك لتقودك لحياة أقوى.

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— MIND POWER AUTHOR —

POWER OF MIND

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How to take control of your thoughts, reprogram your mind, and build habits that lead you to a stronger life

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POWER OF MIND — How to take control of your thoughts,
reprogram your mind, and build habits that lead you to a stronger
life

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Introduction

One night, as I was trying to fall asleep, I found my mind working without permission: a phone call due tomorrow morning, an unpaid bill, an old memory from years ago, and fear of something that never even happened. In that moment I asked myself a very strange question: who is running this machine? Me... or is it running on its own, without asking?

That question is the first real step in this whole book. Because whoever asks it is holding a secret he has been missing for a long time.

The mind is a tool. Like any tool in this world: it either works for you, or it works against you. And the difference between the two is not intelligence, not luck, and not circumstances. The difference is awareness. Are you aware of your thoughts while you are thinking them? Or do thoughts pass through you the way the internet runs through your phone — without you feeling a thing?

This is not a philosophy book. You will find no complex terms, no talk beyond your capacity, and no theories that make you feel small. You will find something much simpler and far more useful: an operating manual. Like the phone manual inside the

box that explains the buttons one by one — except this time the device is your mind: the most expensive device you have ever owned, without anyone ever handing you its manual.

And the promise is clear, in a deliberate sequence:

First, you will learn to take control of your thoughts — because control begins when you are the one doing the thinking, not the thoughts doing the thinking of you.

Then you will take a deeper step: reprogramming your mind — the words you say to yourself every day, and the images you keep repeating inside your head, are the program your mind runs on. And we will learn how to change that program with awareness.

And finally, you will build habits that lead you to a stronger life — because dreams are not finished by enthusiasm. They are finished by small repetition that adds up every day.

Every chapter in this book is written the same way: a short story from real life that you will live with me, then the idea in a few simple points, then one exercise you can finish in minutes, and at the end, a sentence of the week — one sentence you memorize and live with for seven days, until it turns into a habit.

But watch out for one thing: this book will not change your life while it sits closed on a shelf. Nor while it stays closed inside your head while you think the words are nice. This book will work for you when you work on it. So get a paper and pen ready from now — not later — because the exercises ahead are not optional. They are half the book. And the other half is you.

One last thing before we begin. The sentence this whole book stands on, and the one we will go deep into in the first chapter:

Your mind is not you.

And when you truly understand it — not just read it — you have taken the first step on a journey that will change your life. From the next page, we begin.

Chapter One: Your Mind Is Not You

There is one question that, if you learn to answer it correctly, will change your life from its place — with no course and no other book: when you say "I"... who exactly are you talking about?

Most of us answer without thinking: "I means me. This person. The one who moves, speaks, and makes decisions." A logical answer... but incomplete. Because what happens in the next few lines is the cornerstone this whole book is built on. If you understand this chapter well, the six chapters ahead will open for you effortlessly.

And we will begin the way we always do... with a story.

Hisham and the Ten Lost Minutes

Hisham is an employee who rides the metro every morning. A trip from his home at the edge of the city to his job downtown. He knows this trip by heart: walk down the stairs, pass the gate, stop at the same spot on track two, get off at the fourth station. A trip he has made more than a thousand times.

That day was an ordinary day, like every day. Normal crowds. A car packed to the brim. Hisham found a

standing spot by the door, held the rail, and let his mind wander off on its own.

And the mind went. It went to the twelve o'clock meeting waiting for him at work. To the reply he should have given his manager yesterday. To the call with his friend who got upset two weeks ago, and neither of them has called the other since. To a side project he has been thinking about for two months. To the phone bill and the shared subscription. To a word his wife said that morning before he left the house... and he kept chasing it.

The car arrived at the fourth station. People got off. Hisham got off after them, on autopilot, on the route he had taken a thousand times.

And as he walked through the station tunnel, the strange thing happened: he stopped suddenly.

Not because he forgot something. Not because he saw something. He stopped because of one small question that knocked on his head without warning:

"Where was I for the last ten minutes?"

He tried to remember. Nothing. Not one second. Ten full minutes of his life... that did not exist in his memory. His body was standing in the car, his hand on the rail, his eyes open, his ears hearing the

announcements. Everything in him was present. At the station, in the car, on the way. Everything... except him.

He stood in the middle of the tunnel and said to himself the sentence that would come back to his mind years later, and every time he remembers it he feels something cold on his back:

"I was present in all of those places... except my own."

Ten minutes is not much, you might say. Fine — let's do some simple math. Ten minutes on each trip, two trips a day = twenty minutes. In a month = ten hours. In a year = more than five full days of life.

Five full days... and he was not in them. He did not travel or move or experience anything... he simply was not there.

But the important part of Hisham's story is not the numbers. The important part is that, standing in the tunnel, he did something very few people do: he noticed that there is a difference between his body, which was riding the metro... and "him," who was somewhere else entirely. That this difference is real. And that this was the first time he had felt it in years.

The Station Watcher

In that same metro, there is an older man who works as the station watcher. He stands on the platform from morning to sunset, watching the trains come and go. He sees a hundred trains a day... maybe more. Each one coming from somewhere and heading somewhere, carrying a hundred stories inside it.

This watcher knows the schedule of every line. He knows the stations by name. He knows where the crowds are and where it is empty, and he can predict which train will run late before it runs late. He knows this metro inside and out.

But there is one thing this watcher never does: he never boards the trains.

He is not a passenger. He is a watcher. He sees them all... and enters none of them. The train carrying a wedding, the train where a problem is breaking out, the train full of laughter, the train full of crowds and misery — they all pass in front of him, while he stays fixed in his place: seeing, knowing, untouched by any of them.

And when Hisham stopped in the tunnel, he understood — for the first time — that there are two kinds of people on the platform of the mind:

There are those like the watcher: they watch the trains of their thoughts pass, they know their schedules, and they choose at their own pleasure whether to look at one or not.

And there are those like the mistaken passenger: they stand on the platform, a train suddenly stops in front of them, they find themselves inside it without making any decision, and it carries them to the end of the line... even if that line is heading somewhere they never intended to go.

One of them sees. The other becomes part of what is happening around him.

And your mind — my friend — is exactly this station. And thoughts are the trains.

The Idea in Points

First: Your mind is a thought factory that runs without your permission

Nobody asked you: "Would you like to think about what happened at work yesterday? Want me to show you a scary movie about the future? Want me to remind you of something old from 2009?" No. There is no asking permission. This factory runs twenty-four hours a day. It starts working the moment you wake up, before you open your eyes, keeps working while

you eat, work, and drive, and sometimes it works while you sleep — in the form of dreams that finish whatever crossed its mind.

Try something right now as you read: take a few calm breaths, and observe. You will find thoughts coming up for you even in this very moment: "This exercise will make me laugh," "I am thirsty," "Should I finish this chapter or come back to it tomorrow?"... The factory does not shut down just because you are reading.

And this is not a flaw in you. This is the operating system. The mind is a tool whose job is producing thoughts, just as the heart is a tool whose job is pumping blood. You do not get angry at your heart for working. The real problem is not that the factory runs... The problem is that none of us knows there is a factory at all, so we assume every train passing on this platform is us.

Second: You are not the thoughts... you are the one who sees them

This is the most important sentence in the whole book. Take your time with it.

If you can say "I have a thought that I am a failure" — then there is something in you other than the thought. The one who sees cannot be the screen... just as your

eye watching the movie cannot be the screen itself. The one watching is one thing... and what is happening is another.

The thought that says "I don't know how" is just a car on the track: it passed, it exists, you can board it... or you can let it pass. The one that tells you "you are a failure" is not you — it is a thought that passed through the platform of your mind. It came from an old experience, or a word you heard years ago, or a comparison that has no business existing. It is information displaying itself on a screen. You are the one watching the screen.

And when you take this distance... things change. Sadness, anxiety, anger, the feeling of failure — all of them become "weather" that passes, not "you." Like the sky and the clouds: the weather clouds over, and clouds move across the sky, but the sky never becomes the clouds. When you say "I am depressed" while wearing the thought... there is no one left to see. When you say "I notice there is depressed weather passing" — there is you. The Watcher. And the Watcher is present in all weather.

Third: The distance between you and the thought is your freedom

"Whoever does not see does not choose."

If a thought pulls up to the platform and you do not see it — you will not feel it until you are inside it, riding with it to the end of the line, paying its price in time, misery, relationships, and sleepless nights. Exactly like Hisham: ten minutes... without a single second of choice.

But the moment you see the thought approaching, a small distance opens between you. Something like one breath. And in that breath... there is choice.

The thought says "things are hard" — without distance: this misery is you, it arrives without asking. With distance: "I notice a thought saying things are hard... okay, what else?" And from there, you have room to move. The thought says "I am not the kind of person who masters things" — without distance: you shut down. With distance: "That is a thought... it passed. Not an order."

This distance is the difference between being crushed... and being alive. It is the difference between "thoughts control me" and "thoughts pass in front of me." And it — and this is the crucial point — is the first place where "you" are truly free. Because real freedom is not that there are no trains on the tracks... real freedom is that you are the one who chooses whether to board or not.

Fourth: Watching is not rejection... and the platform is not a prison

There is a common misunderstanding about this training we must close right now: that the goal is to block the thoughts. No — and trying to block them is more dangerous than the thought itself.

Try it yourself: do not think of a white mouse for thirty seconds. Most people end up carrying the mouse on their head the whole time. Why? Your mind does not process negation... it processes the image. The one who tells himself "don't worry" all night is, in practice, memorizing worry with a full memory. Blocking is not watching... blocking is boarding in reverse.

The true watcher does not prevent a train from entering the station. He sees it... and that is exactly why he does not go down with it. The station was built for trains to pass through — the beautiful and the ugly — and no station in the world is judged by the number of trains that entered it. The station is judged by one thing only: is there a watcher standing... or not?

And the beautiful thought is also a train: a thought of hope, a thought of a project, a thought of a solution. The watcher sees these too — and chooses among them. Because the difference between "living with them" and "seeing them" is the difference between the

one who moves through his life... and the one life spins around.

See the watching in everyday situations:

- A driver cut you off in traffic? An anger train pulls into the platform at terrifying speed — and you are the one who decides to run after it or let it pass.
- A word was said at a gathering and you are still thinking about it two days later? The thought "he meant something by it" keeps circling around itself — see it, note it if you like... and let it continue its trip.
- A good idea for a problem at work came to you on the commute? Let the watcher catch it before it passes: "I noticed a thought saying: there might be a solution..." — and write it down.

Watching is not rejecting the thought... watching is respecting your right not to be forced to board it.

Chapter Exercise: Watcher Training

This exercise is simple in form, not easy in practice. But if you do it for one week, you will find that it is the first time in many long years that you look at your mind from the outside.

What you need: paper and pen, and five minutes twice a day, for one full week.

1. **Sit in a quiet place.** It does not have to be perfectly quiet — just a place where no one is talking to you. Leave the phone next to you without opening it.

2. **Let your mind bring out what is inside without interfering.** The moment you sit down, the factory will run as usual. Fine. That is exactly what is required.

3. **Every thought that comes up, write it in a fixed format:** "I noticed a thought saying: ..."

– "I noticed a thought saying: what happened in yesterday's meeting is still on my mind."

– "I noticed a thought saying: I will not be able to finish what is on me tomorrow."

– "I noticed a thought saying: I remember so-and-so who spoke to me rudely."

This fixed format is not cosmetic — it is what reminds you, every single time, that there is a "you" seeing, and a thought passing.

4. **No judgment. No decorating. No debating.** Do not write "stupid thought" or "nice thought." Do not try to fix anything. You are not in a repair session...

you are a watcher on the platform recording train schedules.

5. Aim to write five to ten thoughts per session.

If more come up — write them too.

6. And if you find yourself arguing with a thought or trying to convince it that it is wrong

— do not be shaken. That is a thought too. Write it in the format: "I noticed a thought saying: I am defending myself in front of this thought." And continue.

7. And if you miss a session or two days: no guilt, no trial. The watcher does not record absence... he records return — one new session, five minutes, and the count continues.

And four common traps — know them from now:

- **"I cannot find any thoughts":** The factory is running in the background and you are not seeing it. Sit a little longer — the first train appears after a minute or two.

- **"The thoughts repeat themselves in writing":**

Normal — the repetition is the information itself: "This sentence is coming for the third time" means it is one of the ruling rules... nothing else.

- **"The session makes me more tense"**: The first days of the training make life feel noisier — you turned on the light in a room that was dark for years. The noise is not new... it is what was running all along.
- **"I forget to log all day"**: Fine — write the moment you remember. The exercise is not a memory test... it is a training drill.

The sign of success is not that you feel relaxed. The first sessions are sometimes disturbing — you see the true quantity of thoughts inside you for the first time, and that is not a comforting view. The real sign of success is simpler: that you find yourself, in one of these moments, standing on the platform... watching a train pass — that is all. Not riding it. The first time you feel there is a distance between you and what is happening inside your mind... the Watcher in you is awake.

Sentence of the Week

"A thought is a suggestion... not an order."

Write it in your phone, and put it in front of you on your desk. All through the coming week, your mind will offer you thousands of suggestions: "Things are hard," "I am tired," "Everyone is better than me," "There

is no point." Hear all these suggestions with an open mind — the watcher does not close the platform — but keep the boarding decision... yours. A suggestion was never an order. And the watcher in you is the only one who knows the difference.

Before We Close the Chapter...

Hisham's ten minutes could be two hours of your life every day. Twenty hours a month. But now you have something Hisham did not have back then: you know there is a platform at all, and you know there is a watcher standing on it.

But let me ask you one final question before we walk together to the next chapter...

So — the trains of thoughts that stop at the platform of your mind... who is sending them in the first place? Who decides that the "worry about money" train arrives exactly while you are trying to sleep? Who keeps the "fear of tomorrow" train running all day long even while you are sitting to rest?

Hisham would have said: my thoughts, from myself. And that is true... but it is not the whole story. Because there is something outside your mind — something with budgets bigger than the budgets of countries — whose only job is to decide what lights up on your

screen, and what runs your thought factory while you are not paying attention. Notifications. Screens. "Free" apps. There is an entire economy built on one thing only: your attention.

And in the next chapter we will enter this game from the inside — you will see with your own eyes how it is stolen from you every day without you feeling it... and how to take it back down to the very last minute:

"Reclaim Your Mind."

Chapter Two: Reclaim Your Mind

In the last chapter we agreed on two things: that your mind is a thought factory running without your permission... and that you are not these thoughts — you are the one who sees them. And that the Watcher in you is the most valuable thing you own.

But let me ask you the question we left hanging at the end of the last chapter: the trains of thoughts that stop at the platform of your mind... who is sending them? Who decides that the "worry about money" train arrives exactly while you are trying to sleep?

We will answer with another story. The story of a man named Karim... and you will find that it is your story too, and that it happens to you every day.

Karim and the Hidden Bill

Karim wakes up at six in the morning. The first thing he does is not water, not brushing his teeth, not any of the things he dreamed of when he set the alarm. The first thing: reaching his hand to the phone on night mode next to the bed.

He opens the night's notifications: twenty-three of them. He replies to two. Laughs at a third video. Reads a piece of news that bores him. Remembers he has to

send an email to a colleague at work. Gets up to drink water while still holding the phone... and the moment he lifts his eyes from the screen, it is 6:44.

The forty minutes that were supposed to go to prayer, breakfast, and an unhurried start... gone. None of them came back.

At work? Same story. Between one task and the next, a "quick" look at the phone. A look with no goal — a routine look. His hand pulls the phone before his mind makes any decision at all. He opens the app, watches, locks, goes back to work... four minutes each time. One time after another, the whole day.

But the moment that reached Karim... was not at work. It was at night, at home.

His nephew, seven years old, came running to him:

"Uncle Karim! Come play football on the roof!"

Karim answered without lifting his eyes from the phone: "Just one second, sweetheart... let me finish this video."

The second turned into thirty-five minutes.

When Karim looked up, the boy was gone. Not upset, not crying, not saying anything... he walked away without taking an answer. Normal. He was used to it.

And for the first time in a long while, that scene pinched Karim's heart — a real pinch. But what matters is what happened after. Karim sat on the couch, opened the phone settings, the "Screen Time" section. The number: six hours a day. An average of six hours. Every single day.

He went to get a paper and pen and calculated, the way the engineer in him loves to:

Six hours a day $\times$ 365 days a year = 2,190 hours.

$2,190 \div 24 = 91$ full days.

Ninety-one days. Full days, twenty-four hours each. Not sleeping through them, not working through them, not living them with the people he loves... a screen.

And then he remembered a sentence a friend of his said at an old gathering — one he had laughed at back then and called "empty talk": "Karim, you are not working for free... you are working for them for free."

He had done the math right. Karim works for the app companies. A full workday: six hours a day, no salary, no insurance, no weekly day off... and nobody thanking him.

The Idea in Points

First: There is no such thing as free... the price is paid from your attention

Any "free" app you use — did you ever ask yourself: where does it pay from? This thing gets designed, gets developed, runs on servers that cost money, and its developers take salaries in the billions. And where does that money come from?

From ads. And an ad does not reach anything if nobody sees it. And the viewing only happens through one thing: that you stay inside the app for as long as possible. So the only thing the app is designed to take from you is... your attention. Your eyes. The minutes of your life.

The sentence that needs to be engraved in your mind from here to the end of the book: **if you are not paying for the product... then you are the product.**

No one in this world gives you something for free. In everything you take without money, there is a price paid from somewhere else: from your time, from your focus, from your data, from your heart while you watch. Money is a currency, true... but attention is your most expensive currency. Why? Because it is the

only one that never comes back. The pound that went may return... the minute that passed never does.

Second: Addiction is not an accident... it is a design

Pay close attention to this sentence, because it will acquit you of a charge you were never guilty of: **you are not weak. The system is designed.**

Behind every app that takes more of your time than you intended, there is a team of the most skilled engineers and psychologists in the world, working toward one goal measured by the minute: that you stay one more minute. Not a minute for their sake — a digital minute measured by a machine, and every single one of them is taken from your life.

The red badge that pops up over the app — designed to look "urgent" even if the content is trivial. The video that plays by itself — so that even the decision to "press play" is not left to you. The page with no end — so there is no "done" moment to tell your mind: get up.

And the most dangerous tool of them all: **the variable reward**. The exact same mechanism a slot machine runs on. You do not know the next result: the next video might make you laugh, might bore you, might be the most beautiful thing you saw all day. And that uncertainty is precisely what plays on the deepest

instinct in your mind: "Pull one more time... maybe the next one is it." The slot machine tells itself the exact same words... and keeps spinning until it takes the last pound in the pocket.

So the moment you feel you will "just watch one thing for a second" and find yourself a quarter of an hour later — do not say "I am weak." What happened is not weak willpower... it is a complete design working against your will. And that is exactly why the solution is not "stronger willpower." The solution is that you see the game itself... and that is what we are doing right now.

Third: Whoever does not see the cost... cannot choose

Here the law of the first chapter comes back to us: "Whoever does not see does not choose."

Hisham found himself riding a train without seeing it... ten minutes gone. Karim pays ninety-one days a year without seeing the bill. And both are in the same trap: there is no platform to watch from.

So the first step of the reclaiming is not throwing your phone into the sea and living in a cave. The first step is much simpler and much harder at the same time: **that you see the bill with your own eyes.**

Whoever measures, can. The moment the number is written in front of you — not a feeling, not an estimate, a number on paper — half the battle is over. Because the Watcher in you, the moment he sees the "ninety-one days" train parked on his platform... makes a decision. Not because he is angry at himself — because he now knows who is paying the price... and who is collecting it.

Fourth: Your day is a budget... and you are the one spending it

Let us put the final frame on the picture: your day is one balance — about sixteen waking hours. That is all you have, and everything is spent from it: work takes from it, family takes from it, apps take from it, worry takes from it, and sleep takes the rest.

The difference is that your money is accounted for to the last penny: a hundred extra pounds on one bill gets a full hour of thinking, questioning, and reviewing from you. But the six daily hours you spend on a screen? They pass with no bill at all. And that is exactly the secret of the hidden bill: small expenses get audited... and massive ones pass in silence.

So use your accounting mind, but in the right direction: before you open any app — any app — one question only: "The bit I am spending from the

balance... what is it bringing back?" If the answer is "a little laughter" — take your time, you are free and it is your right. But let it be clear information you have chosen... not a theft in the dark. That is the difference between the one who chooses to open... and the one who gets opened.

Chapter Exercise: The Attention Audit

This exercise lasts one week, and it is done once on the first day — the rest is simple follow-up. Get a paper and pen... and open your phone settings:

- 1. Pull up the screen time number for the last seven days.** The name: "Screen Time" on iPhone, and "Digital Wellbeing" on Android. Write the number on the paper in hours — no, not on the phone. On paper. Paper sticks.
- 2. Look at the top three apps eating that number,** and write their names below the number in order.
- 3. Do the yearly calculation:** the number $\div 7$ = daily hours. Daily hours $\times 365 \div 24$ = how many full days a year are you giving to these apps? Write the final number on its own line... and read it out loud. This number is the price of your "free."

4. Lock the notifications of all apps except those where a real human sends something: calls, and real messages. The rest are not notifications — they are invitations to parties being held inside your head... and nobody said you have to attend.

5. The first thirty minutes of your day without the phone, and the last thirty minutes before sleep without the phone. The phone gets locked and placed away from the bed — outside the room if you can. This is the first piece of land you take back for your kingdom... and the most important land of all: the beginning of your day and its end.

6. Every night before sleep: log the day's screen time number. Seven simple marks. At the end of the seven, look at the line... and go ahead and ask yourself: what is this number bringing back?

The sign of success: it is not that the number drops to zero — we are not against the phone, and in a little while you will see that the phone itself can become a weapon in your hand. The sign of success is that the phone buzzes in your pocket... and a moment before you take it out, you find the Watcher in you asking: "This time... am I the one deciding to open, or the notification deciding for me?" If that question happens to you even once a day — the reclaiming has begun.

Frequently Asked Questions

"All my work is on the phone... lock what, exactly?"

No one asked you to lock your work. The distinction is not between phone and no phone — it is between "I am the one who opened it" and "the notification opened me." Your work gets opened in your own time... and the notification gets opened in its time. And this exercise is the tool of that distinction, in numbers.

"The numbers came out scary... I felt like a terrible person."

The opposite: there is no crime here. The count is not a trial — this is the first time you are seeing a real bill. And the one who sees the bill pays less... and the one who does not see it pays in full, for life. Two minutes of feeling bad is fine... and after them, start from the smallest item.

"I tried before, locked the notifications, and went back after two days."

You went back because last time it was a total blackout — and everything that gets shut by force opens by force. This time it is much smaller: one single notification you let go of, and one single screen you lock before sleep. Small beginnings are the ones that

survive... and that is the same one-minute rule, coming in its own chapter.

Sentence of the Week

"If you are not paying the price... then you are the price."

Memorize it just as it is. Every time you download a free app, every time you enter a platform where nobody took a pound from you, every time you watch content for free — remember: someone is paying a price. And the only question you need to keep asking yourself: who is the payer?... And if you can spot no one — then the payer is you.

Before We Close the Chapter...

So, my friend, you have taken back the first thing that was hidden from you: the bill. And you are now standing on the platform of your mind, watching the trains come and go, knowing who sends them, and able to close the platform in front of any train you do not approve of.

But there is something much deeper than that... and in it the good news and the bad news at the same time.

Even if you locked every notification in the world... there is one voice that will never be locked. A voice

that starts working before you open your eyes in the morning, keeps talking to you all day, and changes its words with the mood of the moment: "I am not up to it"... "They will see right through me"... "I am the forgetful type"... "I have always been this way."

Not the voice of the apps. Not the voice of the TV.
Not anyone else's voice at all.

It is your own voice — the words you say to yourself.
The strongest program your mind has ever run... and
the one we monitor the least.

And in the next chapter we will open this microphone,
and see who is really speaking into it... and how to
rewrite the words from scratch:

"The Words You Say to Yourself."

Chapter Three: The Words You Say to Yourself

We came back from Karim's story with something gained: there is an entire economy in this world built on your attention... and you saw its bill for the first time. You won the round that was against something outside your head.

But the next round is harder. Because its opponent is not outside. Its opponent lives inside, uses your own voice, and says things you have been used to for years... to the point that you do them without even hearing them.

The Story of Omar and the Narrator in His Head

He is thirty-one years old, and he runs a small shop-fitting business: decor, electrical work, and finishing. After a year and a half of hard work and saving, the opportunity of a lifetime appeared: a big investor saw the idea of Omar's new project — a small app connecting skilled workers with people — and wanted to hear more. The meeting was Sunday morning.

The night before the meeting, Omar sat at his desk reviewing the numbers. The numbers are good. The project is solid. But every time he looked at the paper,

he found — there is no radio playing inside his head...
no, there IS a radio playing inside his head:

"These numbers will not impress him... they only look good to you."

"Investors like this meet people bigger than you."

"Your words will get tangled... they always get tangled in the big moments."

"And watch out for the profits question... you are terrible at mental math."

He resisted: "Then why am I even here?" So the radio answered: "So you can watch yourself lose the opportunity."

Omar closed the file and fell asleep on that voice.

In the morning, ten minutes before the meeting, standing in front of the place, he heard himself say a sentence out loud without intending to:

"Here we go, Omar... today you are right on schedule to prove you are a failure."

He froze. That sentence was not from the numbers, not from the presentation, not from anything on the paper. It was from inside him.

He walked into the meeting. He spoke well... relatively. But the man who entered that hall was not a man

coming to sell an idea — he was a man coming to apologize for his existence. His voice dropped lower than it should. He agreed to changes he knew were wrong. And he left without getting a follow-up... and the investor thanked him with perfect politeness, with the sentence Omar knows by heart too: "We'll think about it and get back to you."

In the car on the way back, the radio opened: "Told you, Omar... this never wins you anything."

But this time Omar suddenly asked a question he had never asked himself: this sentence... where did I bring it from?

And in the moment of stopping at the red light, the flash came: Omar is nine years old, standing next to his father at work, breaking a glass cup, and his father shouting: "You never succeed at anything!" — twenty-one years have passed since that scene... and the narrator in Omar's head is still replaying the same cassette.

In that moment Omar understood something that shook an idea about himself he had held for years: the voice speaking inside his head... is not his voice at all. It is an old recording, planted when he was small, replaying for twenty-one years... and all his life Omar thought it was "his opinion of himself."

Three weeks later, Omar pitched to other people. Same project. Same numbers. Practically the same man. With one small difference: before going in, Omar had done something with the radio in his head — the exercise you will learn in a few lines. He walked into the meeting... and the investor took his number.

And the story does not say Omar became a millionaire — Omar is still halfway there. The story says something simpler and more important: one project, one set of numbers, one man... and the man is the only thing that changed.

The Idea in Points

First: There is a radio playing in your head all day... and you do not own the switch

The inner dialogue is not passing thoughts — it is a running commentary on your life, broadcast from the moment you wake until you sleep: it judges your look in the mirror, reviews your meal, gets angry at a driver, mocks you when you make a mistake, and doubts you before anyone else does. Thousands of sentences a day.

The problem is not that the radio is playing — that is the operating system we all run on. The problem is that its voice became "the voice of reality": from

hearing it so much, we now call any sentence it says "me" and "my nature." And you never asked yourself Omar's question: this sentence... who wrote it? And when? And is it even true?

Second: You talk to yourself in a way you would never let anyone talk to your closest friend

A moment of honesty right now: if someone — anyone — walked up to your dearest friend and said to him: "You never succeed at anything"... "Don't pitch it, they will see right through you"... "This is too big for you"...

Would you stay silent? No. You would stand in his face. There is no way you would let anyone talk to your friend like that.

The sentences we accept for ourselves every day — in the mirror, on the commute, after any mistake — if they were said to our friend, the whole world would have to answer. So why, when the narrator says them from inside... do we surrender?

The answer is small and scary: because he says them in our own voice. The one who speaks, the one being spoken to, and the one who hears... are all in the same room, and there is no witness outside.

Third: These words are written... and not one sentence of them is carved in iron

And here is the good news. The sentences that repeat in your head did not come from your genes — they are sentences that were written: by a moment like Omar's glass cup, or an old teacher's comment, or a comparison, or mockery from a schoolmate long ago. They were written by experience... and everything that was written can be edited.

The difference between "I can't" and "I'll try and see" is not mere optimism... it is swapping the operating instruction. And the recording that was made when you were nine gets edited by sentences being written in your life right now — when they are repeated more than the old ones.

And the golden rule of editing: do not lie to yourself. "I am the greatest businessman in Egypt" — your mind will throw it out, because it knows it is not honest. The right alternative is a true, believable sentence: "I am well prepared... and I have tried and succeeded before." Editing is not illusion — editing is honesty with yourself.

Fourth: When does the radio get loud?

The radio does not run at the same volume all day. There are three hours when the static peaks, and in

them most of us believe our biggest lies about ourselves:

- **Before sleep:** the end of the day, the battery is drained, and no one is checking the radio. Sentences at this hour dig deeper than at any other time — that is why you toss and turn in bed over an old moment... and you are not tossing over the moment itself, you are tossing over its re-broadcast.
- **After any stumble:** the moment you make a mistake or fall, the radio runs at full volume and issues final verdicts on your entire life from a single stumble. This is not analysis... it is a live broadcast of the old program.
- **In comparisons:** the moment you open social media, the radio takes the highlight reel of someone else's life and turns it into commentary on your own — with old voices and new confidence.

The solution is not silencing the radio during these hours — that is nearly impossible. The solution is that you know the appointment itself: "It is one in the morning... and this is the static hour. Anything said right now is not binding." The sentence that gets carved in at midnight gets reopened in the morning light... and shows its true face. Omar's rule for the

meeting was not "silence the radio" — it was "the radio does not rule during the static hour."

Chapter Exercise: Editing the Words

One week, and a paper and pen. The foundation is the Watcher Training you did in the first chapter — this time on one specific kind of train: words.

1. One day of logging the radio. Exactly like the Watcher Training, but the format changes: instead of "I noticed a thought saying"... write "I heard myself saying: ...". No judgment of the sentence — logging only. Five to ten sentences over the day.

2. Pinpoint the one ruling sentence. Read what you wrote, and choose the sentence that repeats the most and hurts the most. You will usually find it short, and starting with "I". That is the one we will work on.

3. Write its realistic replacement. Not a fantasy dream — a sentence of honesty: "I never get anything right" → "I get many things right, and what I get right takes more than one try." "I can't present this" → "I will prepare well... and try." The replacement gets written on a small paper in front of you, and becomes your phone wallpaper.

4. A week of swapping. Every time you hear the old sentence — and you will hear it — say the replacement immediately, in a low voice or in your head. Do not wait to feel confident first... the sentence is what brings the feeling, not the feeling that brings the sentence. And at the end of each day, put a mark on the paper for every swap you made.

5. And if you need a starting point... these are the five most famous sentences on the radio, and their realistic replacements:

- "I look terrible today" → "This is my look today... and today is not the measure of my life."
- "I made a mistake... I always make mistakes" → "I made a mistake this time... and my whole life still has plenty right in it."
- "Everyone is better than me" → "I am watching their highlight reel... and my reel is being edited too."
- "I am tired of myself" → "I want to change one thing in my day... and it should be very small."
- "I can never succeed at anything" → "I have not tried enough times yet to judge."

Notice: every replacement is not a dream or a goal... it is a realistic reply. And that is the acceptance condition

your mind sets — if the replacement gets rejected, shrink it until it is accepted.

The sign of success: it is not that the old sentence dies — old sentences never fully die. The sign of success is that it drops in rank: from "a fact about me"... to "a passing memory." And the first time you hear it and the replacement comes to you automatically, without thinking — the editing has started writing itself.

Sentence of the Week

"Instead of 'I can't'... 'I'll try and see.'"

Do not wait until you are ready to say it — say it while you are not ready, while you are afraid, while you are unsure. This is not a magic sentence... it is the smallest decision that can be made in a moment of fear. And small decisions are the ones that make it through.

Before We Close the Chapter...

You now own the first thing you need for real change to begin: you can see the narrator inside, you have heard him say "I" while he is not you, and you know his words are paper... and paper can be written again.

But there is a logical question anyone who does this exercise seriously must face: but why? Why does a

repeated sentence gain this much power? Who gave ordinary words — letters on the wind — the authority to dig into your mind?

And the answer is stranger and more beautiful than you imagine: your mind does not ask "is this sentence right or wrong"... your mind asks one question only: "has it been repeated enough, or not?"

And this is the most dangerous rule in the whole book. Whoever understands it will understand why fear grows out of repeated sentences, why some people's dreams come true without them knowing why, and why the one who says "I am tired" every day... feels genuinely tired.

This rule is the next chapter, and I am not exaggerating when I tell you it is the key to everything that follows:

"Your mind believes what gets repeated."

Chapter Four: Your Mind Believes What Gets Repeated

In the last chapter we did something big: we edited a sentence. We heard the narrator in Omar's head, learned that his words are an old recording... and learned how to write an honest replacement. But there is a question we left hanging, and we promised the answer: why repetition, of all things? Why does a repeated sentence become strong enough to steer your actions and your life?

This chapter is the answer. And in it is the rule everything that follows is built on... take your time with it.

The Story of Salim and the Job He Never Looked For

Salim is an accountant, forty years old. Seven years in the same company, the same office, the same chair. The salary is not bad... but it stopped being enough, and the work started running on autopilot.

Salim has been carrying a sentence for years: "At this age, in this country... there is nothing better than this. The market is hard."

This sentence is not Salim's invention. It came from the tea gathering with his friends, from his father's words long ago, from the news that opens every day on "the crisis." It was repeated next to Salim a hundred times... until it sat down on his office chair.

And the strange truth? Salim never looked for another job. Not surrender — he is simply convinced there isn't one. When someone tells him "just try," he answers instantly, without feeling: "Try what, my friend... don't you see what's around you?"

And with the sentence, there is an image. Before sleep, Salim pictures the resignation scene: the manager laughing in his face, the money stopping, the installment waiting, the family suffering because of him... a clear image, in color, with sounds. Repeating every night. And every time it repeats, it becomes clearer and closer — to the point that Salim feels genuine terror in his bed... over something that never happened at all.

One year, his colleague at work — younger in experience, and behind him in many things — got an offer from another company... and accepted. And Salim asked himself for the first time: "He can?... then why not me?"

The old sentence answered in a second, from its corner: "Because the market is hard."

And Salim — for the first time in his life — asked the sentence itself: "And when did you ever work in this market? Where did you see it? Where did you look?"

The sentence... found no answer. For the first time, it stood exposed in front of Salim: it never worked in the market. It only talks about it.

Salim ran a small experiment on himself, no ambition of a revolution: two weeks only, sending his CV to anything that shone. The result after two weeks: 22 companies received the CV, 3 interviews, and one offer... with a better salary.

But that is not the important part. Salim did not start seeing the world in pink — some companies never replied, one interview went badly, and the market truly is not easy. What changed was different: the old sentence said "nothing exists at all"... and the truth was "something exists, but it needs 22 attempts." Salim was paying the price of an image in his head... not the price of reality.

The Idea in Points

First: Your mind is an archive clerk... not a judge

The judge examines: hears the evidence, compares, issues the verdict. Your mind does not do that with sentences. Your mind is an archive clerk sitting at his desk, only counting: how many times was this sentence said? The bigger the count, the bigger the shelf the sentence gets in the archive... until it becomes "known information." And the known is treated by the mind as true — whether it is actually true or not.

"I am not up to it" repeated a hundred times? It becomes a fact. "Money is hard to come by" repeated a thousand times? It becomes a law. "I am bad at math" — learned from a mistaken teacher and repeated for twenty years? It becomes your nature.

From here comes the first question you ask any "fact" you say about yourself: did this happen... or was it only repeated? If the only thing the sentence has is not an experience you lived, but a voice you heard often — then you are not talking about a fact... you are talking about a big shelf in an archive.

Second: The fear is not of the thing... it is of the image that repeats

Let us ask: the one afraid of dogs — did a dog bite him before? Most of them, no. So afraid of what? Of an image that repeated. The one afraid of failure — his real failure is usually far weaker than the failure in his head. And the one afraid of speaking in front of people: was mocked once in reality... and a hundred times in his imagination.

Your mind does not differentiate much between an experience you actually lived... and an image played inside you many times: both run on nearly the same circuits, and the strong image leaves an effect much like the effect of the real thing. That is why Salim felt genuine terror over a resignation that never happened: as far as his mind is concerned, the resignation did happen... every night, on the internal television.

Real fear comes from experience. But most of the fear we feel... comes from the rerun.

Third: The same machine gets programmed both ways... so choose what repeats

And here is the good news. This machine is not programmed for fear only — it has no moral judgment at all. The same machine that stored Salim's dark

images is the same one that can store rosy images and honest sentences... if those are the ones that repeat.

Athletes understood this story early. The professional player rehearses the scene before it happens: he sees himself shooting and scoring... many times, in full detail, until the body itself responds to the imagination almost the way it responds to reality. This is not empty "positive thinking" — it is repetition engineering, working by exactly the same laws as fear... but in the other direction.

And the practical rule becomes simple: something will repeat in your head anyway — that is a fact about humans, and there is no option called "no repetition." The only choice available is: you leave the repetition random, the way you grew up... or you step in and set what repeats.

(And notice the difference between this chapter and the last: there we edited a sentence once and started swapping them. Here we are talking about a whole system — the edit was a text revision... and this chapter is installing a program.)

Fourth: The song you hate... is the strongest proof

There is an experiment that happened to every one of us: a song you do not like, you heard it in the car, the

mall, the phone, the ad... and after a week you found yourself humming it. Without your permission. Without liking it.

Nobody asked your opinion — because repetition does not consult. The song hit your ears a hundred times, so your mind considered it "known"... and the known gets accepted faster than the beautiful. That is exactly what happens to sentences like "I can't," "the world is bad," and "money is hard": not true... but repeated. And the repeated gets accepted — true or not.

And that is why companies pay billions on this exact science. The commercial ad does not sell on the first hearing — it does the song's work to the letter: a short sentence repeated until it becomes "known," and people buy the known even when it is no better than anything else. Companies understood this rule years before us and paid billions into it. The question left for you: do we use the same rule in our own direction... or only let it work against us?

And one final warning before the exercise, because this rule has no conscience: repetition does not ask "is this material useful or harmful?" — it only asks "is it repeating?" So treat what enters your mind like food: it is not only the quantity that matters... the quality matters too. The daily complaining, the negative

comment about yourself in front of people, the news running from morning to night — these are all deliberate repetition sessions... just in the opposite direction. And the most dangerous of them: a complaint said out loud in front of people gets repeated twice — once in the ears of the one listening... and once in yours. He heard it once... you heard it twice.

Chapter Exercise: Deliberate Repetition

One week. Five minutes twice a day. And a quiet place:

1. **Prepare the material.** Your replacement sentence from last chapter's exercise (or a new sentence under the same honesty rule). And with it one real image: a situation that actually happened and you did well — the first time you drove through traffic, the first time you presented and it went through, the first time you fixed something that was stuck. Not a dream... a memory. Memories get accepted faster than dreams, because their real details actually exist.

2. **The morning session — five minutes.** Sit comfortably, take three slow breaths. Then: say the sentence quietly ten times. Then live the image three times: see the scene with your eyes, hear the sounds,

feel what happened in it. No rushing... this is the most important job of your day, not a chore.

3. The same session before sleep — five minutes.

And the phone far from you (for your sleep's sake anyway — remember chapter two?).

4. A daily mark on paper. After each session, a mark. Fourteen marks in the week. This chapter is not about understanding... it is about hours of operation: the program does not get written by reading, it gets written by repetition.

5. If the old sentence shows up during the day — and it will — do not fight it. Like the Watcher from chapter one: "I notice the old program is running"... and continue your day, and return to the new one at the next session.

And if you say "I have never succeeded at anything I can remember": this sentence is the oldest program in the whole book... and yours by every right. But its solution is not hunting for heroics — its solution is shrinking the circle of "success." Returned a trust to its owner? A complete act. Fixed something for someone who needed it? A complete act. Passed an exam while tense? A complete act. The rule: any act you carried from its beginning to its end — without leaving it halfway — is a successful memory fit for repetition...

and your mind accepts it instantly, because it actually happened.

The sign of success: after about a week, you find the new image arriving first. The situation plays on the internal screen... and before fear can play the old one, the new one beats it. That lead is the new programming at work — the same strength as the old fear... but in your direction.

Sentence of the Week

"Your mind does not check for truth... it counts repetition."

Keep it in front of you this week. Every time you hear a "fact" about yourself or about the world — from you or from someone — ask it one question: was this examined... or only repeated? This question alone deprograms half the sentences around you.

Before We Close the Chapter...

You now hold the most dangerous rule in the book: why sentences get carved in, why fear grows without a real reason, and why some people's dreams come true without them understanding why — because what repeats in their head becomes the program they run on, consciously or not.

But there is one last piece of the puzzle... and the hardest piece of them all.

Everything we have done so far is words and images: written sentences, repeated pictures, a tuned radio. And all of it stops at one point — the moment of action. The moment when the question that separates those who really change from everyone who read the books and moved on arrives: "So... when do I start?"

And the automatic reply comes soft and tempting: "Tomorrow... when I'm ready." And tomorrow says "the day after"... a week passes, the excitement drains, and the new program gets locked in the drawer with the books.

The next chapter is the one that closes this door forever. One small rule — one minute of your life only — but whoever walks with it finds it hard to go back afterwards. And you will know its mark from the title:

"The One-Minute Rule."

Chapter Five: The One-Minute Rule

Up to here we have agreed on many things: watch your thoughts, reclaim your attention, edit your words, program your images. Beautiful tools... and all of them stay paper in a drawer without one thing: action.

That is why this chapter exists. It is the shortest rule in the book... and the hardest to apply. And listen well: what is about to be said is the real cure for the sentence we all repeat: "I know everything... I just never start."

The Story of Hala and the Novel That Waited 8 Years

Hala is forty-three, an employee at a telecom company. Since her university days, her dream has been one thing: to write a novel.

Once a year — New Year's Eve exactly — she announces the decision: "This year I write it." And once a year the decision gets locked away in the drawer. "Next month... when I have time." And the free time never comes. The jewelry box gets cleaned out, the kitchen gets renovated, the series must be finished, the phone gets watched until midnight... and everything in the world becomes more important than this story.

And the reason is not that Hala is lazy. The reason is stranger: Hala was never trying to write "a sentence." She was trying to write "a novel." And in her head, the word novel translates itself into one massive image: 300 pages, a full year of work, publishers who will refuse, money that will not return, and a mountain of writing she must climb. And in front of this mountain... the brain does what it always does with mountains: it walks around them.

Until her friend — without meaning to — said one sentence to her in a passing phone call: "Then write just one sentence. Any silly sentence. One sentence every day. That's it."

Hala laughed... and decided to try — to experiment, not to succeed. The agreement with herself became: one sentence a day. And she is allowed to stop after it, freely, with no guilt and no trial.

Day one: she wrote a silly sentence about morning coffee. And closed the notebook the second she finished writing.

Day two: another sentence. She reached five sentences without noticing.

Day three: she had lunch early to catch the notebook. She wrote six pages in a row.

After one year: 240 pages of a first draft of a novel... written.

And the story is not that the one sentence is magic. The story is that the first sentence does one thing only: it opens the gate. And behind the gate, the brain enters a different mode — the mode of "the one who does" — and that is the mode that brings 240 pages without its owner noticing.

(And the book in your hands right now? It was written by exactly this rule: session after session, chapter after chapter, no burnout and no waiting for inspiration. The first sentence brought the one after it... until it reached this very line.)

The Idea in Points

First: Procrastination is not laziness... it is escape from a scene

The first comforting truth: you are not running from the work. You are running from the image.

When you say "I'll start working out," your mind does not see a half-hour of exercise. It sees a picture of a full year: a gym subscription, money, exhaustion, heat, your body after a year, and twenty more pictures in a row. This image is the size of a mountain... and the

brain is programmed to do one thing with mountains: walk around them and move on.

And that is the first meaning of "do not inflate": do not be the one who magnifies the project in front of your own eyes. The novel is not 300 pages... the novel is one sentence. The gym is not a year... the gym is one workout. The picture is not the reality — and whoever spares himself, draws small.

Second: The one minute breaks the gravity

The biggest fuel burn in a car's trip... is the first second of moving. And the biggest energy burn in any work... is the moment of starting itself. After starting, the body is already moving. Before starting, there is gravity.

The one-minute rule breaks this gravity with a simple trick: it puts in front of your mind something so small... that the mountain never appears at all. "One sentence." "One workout." "One page." The mind does not run from something the size of a sentence — there is no mountain as small as a sentence.

And the secret buried here: the one minute's goal is not achievement. Its goal is that you become someone who has "begun." And the one who has begun is in a completely different mode — the mode of the one who works. And the words of the last chapter come back:

beginning is an image repeated in your head, and your mind believes what gets repeated... so when "I am the one who begins" repeats, beginning itself becomes a habit.

Third: Motion creates motion... and a stop is not the end

A body in motion stays in motion. The first sentence brings the second sentence, because the brain continues on the track it is already moving on. That is why on most days Hala went far beyond her sentence.

But there are days when the world is not moving. Days of worry, exhaustion, and a broken mood. And here is the most important part of the rule, the one many people get wrong: "do not inflate" does not mean "never stop." You will stop. A whole week can pass without one sentence.

"Do not inflate" means: when you stop, your step of return is the smallest step there is. Returning is not "finish the novel"... returning is "one sentence." When you lose the track, your return is the first step of the ladder — not a leap to the top. The one who returns with the smallest step never really becomes someone who "went back"... he only continued.

Fourth: Start badly... there is no readiness condition

There is a hidden condition placed on beginnings without us noticing: "I'll start when I'm ready." Then: "when the mood comes." Then: "after things calm down a little." The conditions pile up... and the thing waits where it is.

And the truth everyone skips: beginning never arrives with readiness... readiness is what comes from beginning. The first sentence Hala wrote was silly — and it is also the one that opened the gate. The first workout anywhere is embarrassing. The first hard phone call goes badly... and afterwards it becomes an ordinary thing you do while doing something else.

The equation reversed: the only level required to begin is "the worst acceptable version." Not a full workout — just putting on the workout shirt. Not a good page — one silly sentence in peace. Not a finished work — a first draft nobody will ever see. Quality is not an entry condition... quality is the result of repetition: the one who writes a hundred silly sentences gets the good sentence handed to him. And the one who waits for readiness... only gets the waiting.

And the deeper part: the one minute is not a small amount of work... it is an entry permit. You are not just doing... you are telling your mind one thing,

seriously: "I am the kind of person who begins." And your mind — as we agreed — believes what gets repeated.

Chapter Exercise: The One-Minute Week

One week, and one postponed thing. And the exercise is as simple as it can be:

1. **Pick the one thing.** Not a list — one thing only: the postponed thing that hurts you more than the others. The course? The workouts? The CV? The project? The novel? Choose one and stay with it.
2. **Write its miniature version.** Turn the thing into a sentence so small it makes you laugh: "Open the book and study one word." "Put on the shirt and do one exercise." "Write one sentence." If the version contains the word "hour" — shrink it again.
3. **Execute immediately at its time.** The moment the appointed time comes — morning before anything is best — open and do the miniature version. No negotiations. And if the minute is over: continue freely if you like — the assignment is done... and if you stopped: you still won the day.
4. **Log daily.** Two columns on paper: "Started?" and "Continued?". Starting  is the official success.

Continuation is a bonus star — beautiful but not required.

5. Accountability by starting, not by quantity. If you ask yourself "did I do enough?" — wrong question. The only allowed question: "Did I start?"

6. Want a ready-made list of minutes? A glass of water on waking. Three slow breaths. One page of reading. One short postponed call. Tidying one corner of the room. A message to someone waiting on you. Ten stretching exercises. Writing one stuck idea. Five minutes of updating the CV. Two rak'ahs of prayer. The list is not judged by how long the rest takes... it is judged by the thing before it: the thing you have been waiting on.

7. And watch out for the two traps of the minute:

- **"I started two days... so now I must do an hour every day."** No. A new ceiling = a new mountain. The minute is a fixed ceiling... and the expansion arrives on its own, without a decision.
- **"I missed a whole day."** No restarting the week from zero — that is a mountain plan. Return with the smallest step: one sentence today... and the count continues from where it is.

The sign of success: at the end of the week, count the days you continued after the minute without noticing. On most days you will have continued — and that is not coincidence or luck... it is the physics of beginnings: all the gravity stands on the moment of starting... and the rest is easy.

Sentence of the Week

"Just one minute... and the rest comes on its own."

This sentence will work for you in ways you would not imagine: an early night (just one minute with the lights off...), a postponed call ("I'll talk for one minute only"), and even the plant you keep forgetting to water. Anything that has gravity... the minute breaks it.

Before We Close the Chapter...

You now have the last missing tool: the beginning. You have a platform to watch your thoughts from, an attention bill you can see, inner words being edited, repeated images you choose, and a minute that breaks the gravity of anything.

But there is one final question... the question of energy.

Because the one minute will not work with the same strength every day. There are days when the beginning comes easy, and days when you sit on the bed with

your battery at zero. And the difference between the two days is not willpower... or mood. The difference is a whole system around you: your sleep, your food, your routine, the people you sit with, and the environment you place yourself in.

Some of the things in this world charge you while you stand... and some drain you without you noticing. And in the next chapter we will look at this system from the inside, and see them one by one:

"Who Charges Whom."

Chapter Six: Who Charges Whom

All the tools we have talked about so far were in one place: inside your head. The Watcher on the platform, the bill, the inner words, the images, the one minute... all inner work.

This chapter steps outside a little. Because there is a truth every success book leaves wide open: you are not a brain floating in the air. You are a body... and the body gets charged and drained. And what this chapter talks about is the most practical lesson in the book after the one-minute rule.

The Story of Tarek and the Phone Charger

Tarek is a designer at an advertising company. And Tarek's phone? In the best condition possible: a charger in the car, a charger in the bag, a power bank always fully charged. The battery never drops below half... and if it does, Tarek gets genuinely tense and hunts for the nearest socket.

Tarek himself? Look at him on a Monday night... this is it: four and a half hours of sleep (the app's chapter's bill — remember it?), a quick cup of coffee on the run, nine hours sitting at a desk, and the closest thing to

movement in his day is running after the microbus... and at night, the gathering.

The gathering: the same friends, for years. The same chairs, the same coffee, and the same topics word for word: the country, the prices, the manager, the money, and what happened and never came... three hours of continuous complaining, nine to midnight. Tarek loves them with a true love. But he suffers from something vague: he gets up from the gathering completely drained. He blames it on "work tiredness"... but he is drained without knowing why.

The scene that opened his eyes was small: his phone died in the middle of an important call about a side project he had dreamed of for years... and he sat after the call asking himself, for the first time, a question both silly and terrifying:

"What percentage am I at?"

He does everything for his phone: charges it, adjusts its brightness, closes the apps eating its battery, updates it every month. And his own self — the device that dreams, plans, loves, and walks the earth — has never been treated as a device that needs charging at all.

He ran a one-week experiment he called, for himself, "the charging week": fixed his sleep at one bedtime,

walked twenty minutes every day, cut one day only from the gathering... and put in its place one thing he knows lifts his mood (reading before sleep).

The result after a week? Not a miracle — there are no miracles in this book. But Tarek found himself coming home from work with life in him, and preparing for the side project at night... for the first time in three years. Same job, same salary, same commute... one device got charged right, so it started working right.

And the most important part of that week: Tarek cut off none of his friends — he only adjusted the distribution. And he found among them one who was different: an old friend who watches documentaries and talks about things he is actually doing... this one charges him. Tarek tuned his network... and the network started charging him back.

The Idea in Points

First: Your willpower is a battery... not a factory

No one has infinite willpower. And decisions consume it: what to wear, what to eat for breakfast, answer now or later, start or wait a little... every small decision takes a piece of your battery. That is why at the end of the day you find yourself eating something you are not hungry for, and watching something you are not

enjoying — this is not weakness... this is a battery running out.

Routine is the engineering solution to this problem: when you fix the time of your sleep, your waking, your food, and your work... you lift hundreds of decisions off your back every day. A frozen decision takes no energy.

That is why the person with a routine is not stronger than you — he simply pays less. And the energy difference he saves is what makes some people open a project after a full workday... while others say "no energy" while resting at home.

Second: You are a charging network inside a charging network

Something we all forget: the body that carries your brain needs conditions to work. Sleep is not a luxury — sleep is the charging of the device itself. Food is fuel. Movement is activation. Daylight sets your internal clock. And the people around you... are either chargers or drainers.

We audit everything in our lives: an expenses audit, an internet audit, a fuel audit — and we never audit our energy even once a year. Even though money, if it goes, comes back... and energy drained in a single

ordinary day, gone for good. The energy review is the most precious review of your life... and it takes ten minutes.

Third: There is what charges you... and what drains you

This is not an invitation to cut people off or live in an ivory tower — far from it. But the truth must be said as it is: there are gatherings you leave feeling lighter... and gatherings you leave feeling heavier, having learned nothing new and moved nothing at all.

And the test could not be simpler: after any gathering or call... ask yourself one question: do I feel lighter or heavier? If lighter — that is a charger. If heavier — that is a drainer. And if the drainer is your friends, people you love? Do not cut them off... adjust the dose, and reduce the frequency. The goal is not to isolate yourself from the world... the goal is that your time and energy get distributed with awareness, not by habit.

Fourth: The environment takes decisions instead of you... before you know it

There is a question smarter than "why don't I do what I care about?": "What is there around me that is stopping me?"

The environment takes decisions on your behalf. The phone next to the bed? Two hours of your sleep were decided... without you noticing. The book on the far shelf? Tonight's reading decision was taken. The app on the first screen? An hour of your attention was taken — without anyone asking you.

The engineering solution: instead of fighting the decision every day, change the place where it gets made. The phone outside the room = the sleep decision made once... instead of battling yourself over it every night. The book on the pillow = the reading decision made. The gym bag in front of the door instead of the far closet = the decision made. A supportive environment does not do the effort for you... but it lifts half your daily battles off your back.

The rule: "I am strong and can resist" is an exhausting plan — while "I am smart and will not put myself in the test in the first place" is a plan that survives. Willpower is for surprises... and environment is for ordinary days. And the people who change their lives are not stronger than you in willpower... they simply let the environment work with them instead of dragging them backwards.

Environment check — ten quick questions:

1. Does the phone sleep next to your bed?

2. Is the first thing you open in the morning a screen?
3. Is there a fixed focus spot at home... or is every spot the bed?
4. Is the easiest food available the only food available?
5. Do the tools of the thing you long for require a full "excavation"?
6. Is the gathering that drains you... easier to arrange than any alternative?
7. Is the screen that keeps you up late in the same room as your sleep?
8. Are your workout clothes ready from the night before?
9. Is there a human charger around you... that you are not investing in?
10. Is there a drainer taking from you by habit, not by choice?

Every "yes" is not an accusation — it is a ready adjustment point. And every point you fix... turns a hundred daily battles into one decision, made once and done.

Chapter Exercise: The Charger Audit

One week, a paper and pen, and three decisions only — three, no more:

1. **Write two lists.** "Chargers": five things you know from your own experience charge you (enough sleep? walking? reading? prayer? a call with a particular person?). And "drainers": five things that empty you (the morning phone? a specific gathering? comparisons? late nights on YouTube?).

2. **Choose only three decisions for the week.** One about sleep (the same bedtime every day), one about movement (a twenty-minute walk), and one about people or the screen (remove one thing from the drainers list and reduce it... and put one of the chargers in its place).

3. **Every night: what is your energy out of ten?** One number only on the paper. No analysis, no diary writing — a number.

4. **End of the week: compare the first day to the last.** And choose one decision only to become permanent, without thinking — this is the seed of your new routine.

5. Forbidden to add anything new. This week is not a training load... this week is optimal operation of the battery you have right now.

And if the week breaks in the middle — travel, illness, circumstances, or just life: same smallest-step rule. "I'll restart the whole week" is a mountain plan — take one day instead: the three decisions today, only. The week did not close... it just got shorter. And the routine that can survive a crack is the one that lives.

And if you are unsure where to begin: fix sleep first. The sleep decision is the mother of decisions — it is the main charger for everything else, and the first thing to fall when the environment gets tangled. Fix your sleep... and you have won half the battle before it begins.

The sign of success: there will be at least one day where you do something without "deciding" it — put on your shoes and walk without an inner negotiation, or grab the book before feeling like it. That moment means the routine charged you instead of you paying from your willpower... the device started charging itself.

Sentence of the Week

"You are the battery... the phone is just a device."

This week, take care of your battery the way you take care of your phone: see when you get charged and when you get drained, and close the apps eating it in the background. Because the device you carry with you every day and love... is you.

Before We Close the Chapter...

You now hold the complete system, inside and out: a Watcher on the platform, a bill you can see, words being edited, images you control, a minute that breaks the gravity, and chargers being tuned.

But there is one final objection... and if you have been with me since the beginning of the book, you know it is coming: "All of this is lovely on paper... but the real world is harsher than that. People are exhausting, circumstances are hard, and success has its own people."

The next chapter is the answer to that sentence. Not with debate or persuasion — with names and dates: an Egyptian scientist from a small city on the Nile who turned the world's understanding of chemistry upside down. An actor who lived on the edge and wrote a ten-million-dollar check... years before he could cash it. A girl born into dire poverty in rural America who climbed to the top of the world's media ladder. An

athlete who was told his body was not built for it... and kept going anyway. And a mind whose illness locked it inside a body on a wheelchair, and set the prison of the whole universe free.

Each one of them is a witness to a principle from the chapters behind... and all of them agreed on one thing before they succeeded: they were not waiting for anyone.

The next chapter... is the last big paragraph of this story:

"Real Stories of People Who Changed Their Lives and the World with the Power of the Mind."

Chapter Seven: Real Stories of People Who Changed Their Lives and the World with the Power of the Mind

We have finished six rules. And we agreed at the end of the last chapter that there is an objection coming, as repetitive as the rules themselves: "Nice words on paper... but the real world is harsher than that."

This chapter is the reply. Not with theory or philosophy... with names. Five true stories from five different places, and each story is a living witness to one rule of this book. Read them, and you be the judge.

And after them comes the sixth story... which will be different from the five before it.

1. Ahmed Zewail — A Mind from Desouq That Reached the Nobel

Witness of: "Who Charges Whom"

He was born in 1946 in Desouq, a small quiet city on the Nile. Circumstances of the kind people call "ordinary": a small city, and less than many. But the house he was born into had one different thing: questions were received. The curiosity of a child asking

"why?" was not met with "be quiet"... it was met with seriousness. And that is not a small detail — in the accounting of chargers, it is a charge.

A dream without a title was planted in his head: science. And from that day he chose his environments one after another the way you choose healthy food: the university, the laboratory, the science city, the work team that speaks his language. And in a faraway lab, he worked on something hard for anyone even to imagine: photographing the moment of the chemical reaction itself — the fastest "camera" in history: the femtosecond, one part in a thousand million million of a second... faster than any flash.

In 1999, in Stockholm, the first Egyptian and Arab to take the Nobel in the sciences. From a small city on the Nile... to a moment shorter than any flash.

Zewail did not happen by chance — he was engineered by a charging environment. In his home... and afterwards, he chose it himself, one after another.

2. Jim Carrey — The Check Written Before the Millions

Witness of: "Your Mind Believes What Gets Repeated"

The year 1985. A young actor in Los Angeles, trying without results, his money stretched to the size of the dream. One night, he did something strange: he sat and wrote himself a check. The amount: ten million dollars. The line: "for acting services rendered." And the date: five years from that day. He fixed the check in his wallet, and decided to walk behind it.

Every night, he would take the car up a hill overlooking the city, and imagine in detail: the studio directors saying "We love you... welcome." This scene repeated hundreds of times... the way Salim's dark resignation images repeated — but in the other direction.

In 1994 — before the check's date — it came to pass that he would take ten million dollars for a single film. The exact amount. The check in his wallet... came true. (And later he placed it in his father's grave — his father, the first one who believed.)

And here we must stop for a moment of honesty: this story had no "wish and watch." He was going to acting auditions at the same time, working on his skill, and the repeated image was the bridge that let every loss pass without breaking him. Repetition does not cancel the work... repetition carries you to its door.

3. Oprah Winfrey — The Girl Who Changed the Story

Witness of: "The Words You Say to Yourself"

She was born in rural Mississippi, in dire poverty, in a childhood harsh by every measure childhood is measured by. The world was ready to tell her one broken story about herself: "You are a girl of your circumstances... the story ends at these borders."

She refused this story — not once, every day. Over years, she changed the person speaking in her head about her: from "what happened to me" to "what I will do." And she moved from the mirror that audits, to the mirror that thanks: a small nightly gratitude — five things from the day worth being thankful for.

The girl the world had written a ready-made story for... became one of the biggest names in the history of media, and her sentence is now repeated in millions of mouths: "You become what you believe."

The first thing Oprah changed was not her job or her look... it was the sentence she said to herself.

4. David Goggins — The Minute That Opened the Marathon

Witness of: "The One-Minute Rule"

In his twenties, he weighed almost three hundred pounds, had asthma, worked a job far from any dream, and said worse things about himself than all of that. One night, drained from his day, he watched a documentary about the elite units of the US Navy... and spent the rest of the night saying to himself: then why not me?

In the morning, he went out to run. The first walk nearly killed him — his body was distances away from sport. The beginning was smaller than small: one step after another, up to the first street. The next day... he went back. The day after... he went back. The only mission was: "return today as well" — the one-minute rule, walking on two legs.

The result after years: the US Navy's elite unit (their hardest training), superhuman marathons, and a world record in pull-ups: thousands of reps in a row. And the rule he still teaches people to this day is harder and simpler than all of it: "When your mind tells you it is over... you are only 40% done."

Goggins did not wait for his body to be ready or his enthusiasm to arrive. One day, he did one small thing... and after that, every day was the smallest decision of the day: return.

5. Stephen Hawking — The Fastest Mind in the Slowest Body

Witness of: "Your Mind Is Not You"

At twenty-one, a brilliant PhD student at Cambridge... came the diagnosis that stops stories: a disease that shuts down the nerve cells, and the traditional story says: "two years left."

The expected novel ended there. The real one began.

The body surrendered itself piece by piece: the legs, the hands, the voice. Hawking sat in the chair... and his mind became the one that moves. He reached places his body never reached: the edges of time, the borders of the black hole, and a small radiation that got named after him. And he wrote "A Brief History of Time" — a book of theoretical physics that sold millions of copies and entered the homes of people who cannot tell two equations apart. And he lived to 76... meaning 55 full years after the "two years." And his laugh was more famous than the laughs of far healthier men.

The disease imprisoned his body completely... and his mind never entered the prison. That is why Hawking is our first chapter, walking: you are not the body. Not even the circumstances. You are the one who sees.

The Common Denominator

Look at the five together: one from a small city on the Nile. One who slept for years with a paper check in his wallet. One the world had written a ready-made broken story for. One whose brain told him "it's over" while he was at his first 40%. And one who left his body entirely... and his mind reached the edges of time.

Not one of them waited for ideal circumstances. Or permanent enthusiasm. Or a miracle coming down from the sky.

Three things only repeated across the five stories: **they saw**, like the Watcher. **they repeated**, like the program. **they began**, like the one minute. Everything else was details.

Apply the Witnesses to Your Life

The stories are not for amazement... they are for use. Take your witness and take your beginning from him:

- **From Zewail — for the environment:** the first thing you control is not your talents... it is what surrounds you. A whole chapter was spent auditing your home for a reason — first step, tomorrow morning: remove one drainer from your day.

- **From Jim Carrey — for the programming:** where is the "check" in your wallet? One honest sentence repeated in front of you every day. First step: make your replacement sentence your phone wallpaper today.
- **From Oprah — for the words:** what is the ready-made story written about you? Log it, and edit it with an honest sentence. First step: write the first line of the true novel tonight.
- **From Goggins — for the beginning:** where is your "first street"? The smallest version of the postponed thing — one workout. First step: one minute of it before sleep tonight.
- **From Hawking — for the watching:** where is the "it's over" sentence in your head? See it as a train passing — and you are the one on the platform. First step: notice it next time, without boarding it.

Five steps... each one of them can be done today. And all five together? That is day one of the coming 21-day plan.

6. The Sixth Story: You

The sixth story has no name and no date... it is still being written.

You are the one who has read seven chapters up to this line. The one who now knows he has a platform to watch his thoughts from, a bill he pays for every day, an inner voice being edited, repeated images he chooses among, a minute that breaks the gravity, chargers being tuned... and living witnesses of flesh and blood saying that none of this is imagination.

The five previous stories are written and done, and they will not change. As for the sixth — its next passage is being written right now... in the coming lines of your own life.

And the beautiful thing about this story is one thing: you are not its narrator.

You are its author.

"But My Circumstances Are Harder"

The objection in the head of one out of every two readers of these lines must be met with honesty:

"Nice... but I am not Zewail or Oprah. My circumstances are harder."

The truth? Most of the five said this exact sentence at one point or another. Jim Carrey slept in a car on the point of falling apart — and said it. Oprah was born into dire poverty — and said it. Goggins had asthma

and a body far from any athletic dream — and said it. Circumstances are not excuses... circumstances are the starting ground of every one of them.

And the difference between you and them is not in the circumstances... the difference is one small point: each of them stopped once and said: "Then I will tell my story too... with the tools I have right now." Not with dream tools. Not with anyone else's tools. And from there, the story began.

And one last thing honesty deserves: the five stories did not happen in a day — they took years. The first year in each of them looked like the first year of any story starting today: small steps, broken days, returns made with the smallest step. The only difference? They were seeing... even in the middle of the fog.

Chapter Exercise: Choose Your Witness

- 1. Return to the five stories, and choose the one character that "pinched" your heart.** Not the most impressive... the one that pinches. The difference between them is the difference between "nice" and "this one is about me."
- 2. Write next to their name the rule they are a witness of.** If you have forgotten it, go back to its chapter title — that counts as review too.

3. Write one sentence under the two of them:

"This rule helps me right now in..." — and open onto a real tangle that hurts, not a rosy one.

4. Before you close the book tonight: execute the first minute. One minute of the rule you wrote — the way we learned five chapters ago.

The sign of success: that a year from now, you can sit down and tell the sixth story... and tell it right.

Sentence of the Week

"None of them had ideal circumstances... they had a decision."

Before We Close the Chapter...

That is it, my friend. The rules are done... and the witnesses are done. And the objection we opened the chapter with, we answered with five stories that leave no reply.

Only one thing is left in this book — the last real thing in it: how to turn everything that came before into a plan that breathes. Not words to memorize... a schedule to make. In the ending: a last message from my heart to you... and the plan of the first 21 days of your new life, day after day, step after step.

The next chapter is not a chapter at all... it is the first day of the rest:

"The End — A Last Message and the First 21-Day Plan."

The End: A Last Message... and the First 21-Day Plan

A Last Message

You have arrived.

Not "you finished the book"... you arrived. Because this book is of a special kind: it does not finish with reading... it finishes with working. And you, from the moment you read the first chapter, the book started finishing without you noticing.

I want to say two things before we part on paper.

The first thing: thank you. Not a courtesy thank you — a real one. To you alone. Everything said in the seven chapters behind was only a suggestion... and you are the one who repeated, and you are the one who began. I wrote... you are the one who worked.

And the second thing, and it is the most important: you now hold the strongest thing a human being can possess. Not because you memorized written words — because you have become one who sees. You know your mind is a factory that runs without your permission. You know thoughts are trains and you are the one on the platform. You know your attention is a bill being paid and you are the one signing it. You

know the voice in your head is your own voice — and when you edit half of it, you edit your life. You know your mind believes what gets repeated... so you choose what repeats. And you know the hardest thing in the world is the first minute... and the easiest thing is to return with the smallest step.

The whole book in three words: **See. Repeat. Begin.**

If you forget everything... keep these three.

And let me tell you a small secret on my way out: I wrote this book... and I am the first one who needs it. The words in it are not wisdom being handed around — this is revision. And the one who does not revise... lets himself forget, and we all forget. So do not blame yourself if you return to this book from the beginning again. Returning is not weakness... returning is half of knowledge.

Now only one thing remains: the schedule.

The First 21-Day Plan

The idea is simple: 21 days = 3 weeks. Each week is a round through the rules of the book... but the tool changes:

- **Week One: See** — you try every tool once.

- **Week Two: Anchor** — the tools turn into a small daily routine.
- **Week Three: Integrate** — the tools have become life.

Week One — See (Days 1-7)

The rule of the week: one day = one tool, once. No mastery, no ambition. The only goal is that you see each tool's face:

- **Day 1 — The Watcher:** a 5-minute session. Paper and pen: "I noticed a thought saying: ..." no judgment. Five thoughts.
- **Day 2 — The Bill:** open your screen time and write the number on paper. Do the yearly calculation. And lock the notifications that are not necessary.
- **Day 3 — The Radio:** all day long, log: "I heard myself saying: ..." and at the end of the day, pinpoint the ruling sentence.
- **Day 4 — The Edit:** write the replacement for your ruling sentence — a sentence of honesty. Fix it in front of you and make it your phone wallpaper. And every time you hear the old one, say the new one.

- **Day 5 — Deliberate Repetition:** a 5-minute session: the sentence ten times in a low voice, and one real image of something you did well, three times.
- **Day 6 — The One Minute:** pick your postponed thing, write its minute version, and execute it immediately. If you stop after the minute — you still won.
- **Day 7 — The Chargers:** two lists: five chargers and five drainers. And choose only three decisions for the coming week (sleep, movement, people or screen).

Week Two — Anchor (Days 8-14)

The small daily routine — all of it together no more than a quarter of an hour:

- **Morning (about ten minutes):** deliberate repetition, 5 minutes + the one minute on your postponed thing + waking up at the same time.
- **Evening (five minutes):** the Watcher + the energy question: how many out of ten? + today's screen time number.
- **Throughout the day:** edit the sentence every time you hear the old one... and continue the three decisions you chose on day 7.

- **Day 14 — mid-plan review:** a quarter of an hour with yourself: what is working? What stopped? Adjust, but do not close down anything that is working.

Week Three — Integrate (Days 15-21)

- Continue week two's routine exactly as it is — **without any additions.** The one minute became half an hour? Normal. The new sentence arrives before the old one? That is the success now.
- **Day 18:** choose one decision only to become fixed for the whole coming month — this is the seed of your new routine.
- **Day 21 — the big day:** write yourself a small message: "Today, after 21 days..." and what changed. And write the first line of the sixth story: "A year from now, I..."

One last note about the plan: this plan will not be completed perfectly. There will be lost days — and that is not failure, it is data. The day that gets lost, the day after it says: return with the smallest step... and continue the count. The one who continues after falling... is the one who truly continues.

The Last Line

This book began with the story of a man who got off the metro... and was not there. And here they are now on the platform in front of you: Hisham, Karim, Omar, Salim, Hala, and Tarek — all of them watching you from afar... the way the Watcher sees.

And the sixth story... its notebook opened with the first line you read here.

Write it well.

And always remember — in hardship and in ease, and in the moment the world presses on your chest:

A thought is a suggestion... not an order.

And you are the one who decides.

— Mohamed Ismail Abdelaziz

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A Note

The book in your hands is **the first book in the "Power of Mind" series.**

The series is a long journey with the mind — and each book in it opens a new world: the mind and money, the mind and relationships, the mind and health, the

mind and crisis management... with the same spirit that carried you to this point: simple words, stories from life, and exercises that work from the first day.

And the story is only at its beginning...

And wait for us in the next one.

— Mohamed Ismail Abdelaziz — Author of the "Power of Mind" series